



# Deconstructing the Essential Standard

*Clarifying what students must know and be able to do.*

## Why this meeting matters

Teams often think they agree on a standard until they start defining what proficiency actually looks like. This meeting creates shared clarity.

Meeting 6 · Wednesday, October 21, 2026 · 45 minutes

|            |                                                    |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Focus      | What exactly do we expect students to learn?       |
| Leave with | Draft learning targets for the essential standard. |

## Agenda — step by step

| Time      | What the team does                                                                          |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0–5 min   | Revisit the standard. Re-read your essential standard together.                             |
| 5–15 min  | Unpack it. Identify the key concepts, skills, vocabulary, and level of rigor.               |
| 15–35 min | Break into learning targets. Turn the standard into smaller, teachable, assessable targets. |
| 35–43 min | Write "I can" statements. Put each target in student-friendly language.                     |
| 43–45 min | Prioritize. Decide which targets matter most to assess.                                     |

### Where we're going next → Meeting 7

Defining Proficiency — Agreeing on what "learned it" means.